



five-wicket haul. She has come a long way in a short time and promises a lot more. Kranti was well supported by the other Indian bowlers. Amy Jones was the only England batter who looked comfortable. But for her counterattacking 52 off 62 balls, the host would have been in even deeper trouble.

Because of those five wickets, Kranti became the first woman to make it to the Lord's honours boards for Tests. Before long, she was joined by her teammate Yastika Bhatia, who made a brilliant hundred to help India move into a commanding

position. She thoroughly deserved to become the first female batter to make it to the board.

Yastika's performance was all the more remarkable because she was returning from an ACL injury that had kept her out of the ODI World Cup. She also kept wickets throughout the match. Richa Ghosh, who gave up the gloves, took a stunning reflex catch in the second innings. Richa shone with the bat, too. She hit a quickfire unbeaten 50 to help India declare in the second session on the third day. Sophie Ecclestone gave England something

Working in tandem: Smriti Mandhana (right) laid the foundation with a fluent 83 in the first innings before Yastika Bhatia's (left) superb century tightened India's grip on the historic Women's Test at Lord's.

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to cheer about as she picked up five wickets and earned the right to have her name on the honours board.

India's declaration left England to negotiate a long, difficult final session against a sharp Indian attack riding high on confidence.

Kranti impressed yet again. Her